Module 2 timeline

Changelog · Last updated 9 August 2026

Equipment and technical help: Please refer to the BIOL2022 Canvas site for the current technical officer's contact details and arrangements. When requesting help or equipment, include your project name, group name, and practical time. Clare, technical staff, and demonstrators will be available during practical sessions to discuss expectations and project plans. Your group should aim to be self-sufficient outside practical times. For some projects, you will be able to take gear home straight away to run a pilot study; for others, plan now and pick up gear in consultation with technical staff.

Module 2 welcome · Project information · Practical resources · Report instructions

Submission deadline **Friday 25 September 2026 at 23:59**

Week	In your timetabled session	Between practical sessions and in your own time
Weeks 2–3 10–23 August	**Sign up to a project group for Module 2 in your Prac Session.** Everyone in your group must attend the same prac session.	**Choose a direction:** Review the project information. Make sure all group members are in the correct Canvas group.
Week 4 24–30 August	**Plan and pilot:** Discuss and plan the project, then form a hypothesis and predictions. Design a simple main experiment you can analyse with familiar statistics. Sketch the expected graph and decide which statistics to use, and why. Draft data sheets and work out the equipment you need. Pick up gear for the pilot if needed. For some projects, you will be able to take gear home straight away to run a pilot study. For others, plan now and pick up gear in consultation with technical staff. Everyone contributes to the planning.	**Run the pilot:** Plan and run it before Week 5. In your own time, continue pilot work, read the literature, and begin report preparation.
Week 5 31 August–6 September	**Refine and run:** Work with your group; finalise the main design in light of the pilot and literature. Clarify the response and explanatory variables and the analysis. Pick up any remaining gear. Run the main experiment and collect and collate the data as a group.	**Collate the data:** Keep one shared Excel/Google Sheets workbook with metadata and a clean results array. Finish data collation before Week 7 if possible.
Week 6 7–13 September	**Use the period for project work.** There is no structured practical this week. Use the time to finish data collection, troubleshoot, and organise the group dataset.	Make sure everyone contributes to collecting and organising the data.
Week 7 14–20 September	**Analyse and interpret:** Work with your group; finalise data collation and metadata (no more than 30 minutes). Metadata should cover group members, dates, sites, response variables	**Begin the report:** Finish your analyses and graphs. Draft the Introduction, Methods, and Results using the report instructions and rubric.

Week	In your timetabled session	Between practical sessions and in your own time
	and units, explanatory variables (treatments / levels / continuous variables), and column explanations. Include anything that would help you understand your project and data if you were to publish it for the world to see and understand, such as what the columns in your data sheet mean. Spend the remaining time (at least an hour) learning to plot, analyse, and interpret in Excel and R or SPSS. Collaboration is fine, but each student analyses independently and decides on plots and statistical output.	Continue your data analysis if you have yet to complete it. Start drafting your report: begin with a framework for the Introduction, Materials and Methods, and Results. You could leave the Discussion until you have finalised your Results.
Deadline	**Finalise submission:** Use the report-writing guidance; finalise analyses, statistical output, and figures. Prepare the group Excel file with metadata, a clean data array ready to import into a statistics package, and supporting worksheets. Name the file Day-Time-Project (e.g. WED2-4pmProj4A). Each student works on their own report, results, graphs, and presentation. Each student should complete their own Results section and graphs, decide what to include in their individual report, and decide how to present the data and associated statistics.	**Submit both components.** One group member submits Report 1: Group data submission (the group data file). Every student submits Report 1 (individual report). Both are due Friday 25 September 2026 at 23:59.